

# Xinyuan Yang

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🌐 <https://xinyuanyang.github.io>

## Education

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| <b>American University</b><br><i>PhD in Political Science</i>                                                                                                                                                                                      | <i>Sept 2022 – Present</i>  |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>◦ <b>Research Area</b> Political Methodology, Computational Social Science, Comparative Politics</li><li>◦ <b>Committee</b> Jeff Gill (Chair), Tongtong Zhang, Ryan T. Moore, Gary King (External)</li></ul> |                             |
| <b>Harvard University</b> <i>Visiting Graduate Student, Teaching Fellow</i>                                                                                                                                                                        | <i>Sept 2024 – May 2025</i> |
| <b>American University</b><br><i>MS in Data Analytics</i>                                                                                                                                                                                          | <i>Sept 2020 – May 2022</i> |
| <b>University of Wisconsin - Madison</b><br><i>BA in Political Science</i>                                                                                                                                                                         | <i>Sept 2015 – May 2019</i> |

## Research Interests

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- Political Methodology: Bayesian Nonparametric Model, Spatial Temporal Model, Survey Methodology, Machine Learning
  - Comparative Politics: Conflict, Political Economy

## Selected Work in Progress

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1. A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Framework for Predicting Conflict Intensity  
**Xinyuan Yang**
  2. How Does Chinese Foreign Development Finance Incite Conflicts in Sub-Saharan Africa  
**Xinyuan Yang**
  3. A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data (under review at *Political Science Research and Methods*)  
**Xinyuan Yang**, Jeff Gill
  4. Dynamic Contrastive Contextual Embedding for Ideal Points Estimation  
Yuki Mikiya (Keio University), Kentaro Nakamura (Harvard University), **Xinyuan Yang**
  5. A New Response Method for List Experiment (under review)  
**Xinyuan Yang**, Qingya Xu, Kaitlyn DaVisio, Ali Amini, Jeff Gill

## Conferences

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| <i>A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>               | <i>September (Scheduled), 2026</i> |
| <i>A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. 2026 International Symposium on Spatiotemporal Data Science</i> | <i>August (Scheduled), 2026</i>    |
| <i>A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. Polmeth 2026</i>                                                | <i>July, 2026</i>                  |
| <i>A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data. Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference</i>              | <i>January, 2026</i>               |

*A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data. Latin American Political Methodology Annual Meeting*

*November, 2025*

*Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Prediction of Conflict in Sub Saharan Africa. Polmeth 2025*

*July, 2025*

## Grant and Scholarships

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|---------------------------------------------------------------|----------------|
| <b>AY2026-2027 SPA PhD Student Funding Award</b>              | <i>\$28000</i> |
| <b>Polmeth Travel Grant 2025</b>                              | <i>\$500</i>   |
| <b>Neil and Ann Kerwin Doctoral Fellowship 2025</b>           | <i>\$10000</i> |
| <b>EITM Certificate Scholarship Summer 2023</b>               |                |
| <b>Kogod School of Business Merit Scholarship 2020 - 2021</b> | <i>\$15000</i> |

## Teaching Experience

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| <b>Teaching Assistant</b>                                           | <i>American University</i> |
| <i>STAT-616/GOVT-696 Generalized Linear Model</i>                   | <i>Spring 2026</i>         |
| <i>STAT-618/GOVT-618 Bayesian Statistics</i>                        | <i>Fall 2025</i>           |
| <b>Teaching Fellow</b>                                              | <i>Harvard University</i>  |
| <i>GOV 2017 Applied Bayesian Statistics for the Social Sciences</i> | <i>Spring 2025</i>         |
| <i>GOV 2003: Quantitative Social Science Methods, II</i>            | <i>Fall 2024</i>           |

## Professional Services

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|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| <b>Political Analysis</b> <i>Replication Analyst</i>                         | <i>Fall 2023 – Summer 2024</i> |
| <i>Editorial Assistant</i>                                                   | <i>Fall 2022 – Summer 2024</i> |
| <b>Center for Data Science</b> <i>Graduate Student Fellow</i>                | <i>Fall 2022 – Present</i>     |
| <b>Spring Methodology Reading Group 2024</b> , American University           | <i>Spring 2024</i>             |
| <i>Graduate Coordinator</i>                                                  |                                |
| <b>Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS)</b> , Harvard University | <i>Fall 2024 – Present</i>     |
| <i>Graduate Student Fellow</i>                                               |                                |
| <b>IQSS Applied Statistics Workshop</b> , Harvard University                 | <i>Fall 2024 – Spring 2025</i> |
| <i>Graduate Coordinator</i>                                                  |                                |

## Skills

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**Languages:** Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), German (Limited Working)  
**Programming:** R, Python, JAGS (MCMC), LaTeX, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, Stata, SQL